

ESTAS-AQUABC Tutorial: Getting Started

2026-02-26

Contents

ESTAS-AQUABC Tutorial: Getting Started	2
Table of Contents	2
1. Overview	2
What data files are used?	3
2. Prerequisites	3
Quick environment setup	3
3. Starting the Application	4
Option A: Development mode (recommended for this tutorial)	4
Option B: Production deployment	4
4. Application Layout	4
Navigation Pages	4
5. Tutorial Exercise: 30-Day Simulation	5
Step 1: Dashboard Overview	5
Step 2: Building the Model	5
Step 3: Exploring Input Files	6
Step 4: Reviewing Parameters	7
Step 5: Setting Initial Conditions	8
Step 6: Configuring Model Options	8
Step 7: Configuring the Simulation	9
Step 8: Running the Simulation	10
Step 9: Viewing Results	11
Step 10: Analysing Mass Balance	13
Step 11: Comparing with Observations	13
6. Working with Scenarios	13
Saving a Scenario	14
Loading a Scenario	14
7. Geographic Visualization	14
8. Tips and Troubleshooting	14
Performance	14
Common Issues	15
Navigating Efficiently	15
File Safety	15
9. Data Files Reference	15
Input Configuration Files (INPUT*.txt)	15
Key Input Data Files (INPUTS/)	16

Output Files (OUTPUTS_30day/)	17
Observation Files (OBSERVATIONS/)	17

ESTAS-AQUABC Tutorial: Getting Started

A step-by-step practical guide to running the ESTAS-AQUABC ecological model using the Shiny web interface

Table of Contents

1. [Overview](#)
 2. [Prerequisites](#)
 3. [Starting the Application](#)
 4. [Application Layout](#)
 5. [Tutorial Exercise: 30-Day Simulation](#)
 - [Step 1: Dashboard Overview](#)
 - [Step 2: Building the Model](#)
 - [Step 3: Exploring Input Files](#)
 - [Step 4: Reviewing Parameters](#)
 - [Step 5: Setting Initial Conditions](#)
 - [Step 6: Configuring Model Options](#)
 - [Step 7: Configuring the Simulation](#)
 - [Step 8: Running the Simulation](#)
 - [Step 9: Viewing Results](#)
 - [Step 10: Analysing Mass Balance](#)
 - [Step 11: Comparing with Observations](#)
 6. [Working with Scenarios](#)
 7. [Geographic Visualization](#)
 8. [Tips and Troubleshooting](#)
 9. [Data Files Reference](#)
-

1. Overview

ESTAS-AQUABC is a coupled hydrodynamic–biogeochemical model for simulating water quality in aquatic systems. The model couples:

- **ESTAS** — a finite-element hydrodynamic transport solver (25-box Curonian Lagoon domain, advective + dispersive transport)
- **AQUABC** — an ecological/biogeochemical module with 36 state variables and 318+ calibratable parameters covering phytoplankton, zooplankton, nutrients, dissolved oxygen, carbon cycling, metals, and sediment fluxes

This tutorial uses the **Python Shiny web interface** to walk you through a complete model run using the pre-configured data files shipped with the repository. By the end you will have:

- Built the Fortran executable from source
- Configured and executed a 30-day simulation

- Inspected model parameters and initial conditions
- Plotted output variables and input forcing timeseries
- Evaluated mass balance results
- Compared model output against observations

What data files are used?

All input data is already present in the `INPUTS/` directory (89 files). The tutorial uses `INPUT_30day.txt` — a lightweight 30-day configuration (days 6209–6239, year 1998) that completes in a few minutes on a modern machine. The full 365-day configuration (`INPUT.txt`) is also available for later exploration.

2. Prerequisites

Requirement	Details
Operating System	Linux (tested on Ubuntu 22.04+)
Fortran Compiler	<code>gfortran</code> (GCC 9+) or Intel <code>ifort/ifx</code>
Python	3.10 or newer
Python packages	<code>shiny</code> , <code>plotly</code> , <code>pandas</code> , <code>numpy</code> , <code>openpyxl</code> , <code>ipywidgets</code> , <code>shinywidgets</code> , <code>fpdf2</code> (see <code>shiny_app/requirements.txt</code>)
Make	GNU Make
Browser	Any modern browser (Chrome, Firefox, Edge)

Quick environment setup

```
# Navigate to the project root
cd /path/to/AQUABCv0.2

# Create a virtual environment (one-time)
python -m venv .venv
source .venv/bin/activate

# Install Python dependencies
pip install -r shiny_app/requirements.txt

# Verify gfortran is available
gfortran --version
```

If you are using the pre-configured server deployment, the environment is already set up at `/opt/micromamba/envs/shiny/` and the app runs as a systemd service.

3. Starting the Application

Option A: Development mode (recommended for this tutorial)

```
cd /path/to/AQUABCv0.2
source .venv/bin/activate
shiny run --reload shiny_app:app
```

Open your browser to **http://127.0.0.1:8000**.

Option B: Production deployment

If deployed via `shiny_app/deploy.sh`, the app is accessible on the machine's HTTP address (port 80 via nginx reverse proxy). Check status:

```
sudo systemctl status shiny_aquabc
```

4. Application Layout

The application has a **sidebar navigation** on the left and a **main content area** on the right. The header bar at the top provides access to the **Changelog** (journal icon), **State Variables Reference** (question mark icon), and **Settings** (gear icon).

Navigation Pages

#	Page	Purpose
1	Dashboard	Quick Run button, system status, simulation config summary, run log
2	Model Structure	Interactive network diagram of all state variables and interactions
3	Model Build	Compile the Fortran source code (gfortran/ifort, release/debug/fast)
4	Model Config	Configure simulation parameters, run the model, set output options
5	Input Files	Browse, preview, and analyse all files in INPUTS/ with map display
6	Parameters	View and edit the 318 model constants in WCONST_04.txt by category
7	Initial Cond.	View and edit initial concentrations for all 36 state variables
8	Model Options	Toggle model switches (zooplankton, redox, light, cyanobacteria, etc.)
9	Scenarios	Save/load named scenario presets (parameters + ICs + options)
10	Plots	Visualise model output, input timeseries, and data previews
11	Mass Balance	Calculate and display element mass balance (N, C, P, Si)

#	Page	Purpose
12	Observations	Load observation data and compare against model output
13	Map	Geographic 3D map visualization of the model domain

5. Tutorial Exercise: 30-Day Simulation

This exercise walks through every major page of the application using the bundled Curonian Lagoon dataset.

Step 1: Dashboard Overview

1. Click **“Dashboard”** in the sidebar (it is selected by default on startup).
 2. You will see three main sections:
 - **Quick Run / Stop buttons** and a run timer at the top
 - **System Status** (left) — shows OS, Python version, available executables, current model configuration, and the command that will be executed
 - **Simulation Config** (centre) — displays key parameters loaded from the selected `INPUT*.txt` file (base year, time period, steps/day, folders)
 - **Run Log** (right) — shows real-time output when a simulation is running
 3. Review the **System Status** panel. It shows:
 - The selected executable (default: `ESTAS_II`)
 - The selected input file (default: `INPUT.txt`)
 - The number of input files found in `INPUTS/`
 4. **Do not click Quick Run yet** — we will first build the executable and configure the simulation.

Tip: The “Model Config” button below the System Status panel is a shortcut to the Model Config page.
-

Step 2: Building the Model

Before running a simulation, you need a compiled executable.

1. Click **“Model Build”** in the sidebar.
2. The page has three columns:
 - **Build Configuration** (left) — compiler, build type, and options
 - **Available Executables** (centre) — list of compiled executables
 - **Build Log** (right) — compilation output
3. **Configure the build:**

- **Compiler:** Select `gfortran` (GNU) (default, recommended)
 - **Build Type:** Select `Release` (optimised, good for production runs)
 - Leave “**Clean before build**” unchecked for a normal build
 - The **Target Executable** will show `ESTAS_gf_release`
4. Click the “**Build**” button.
 5. Watch the **Build Log** panel on the right. The compilation takes approximately 30–60 seconds depending on your machine. You will see:
 - Individual Fortran source files being compiled
 - Library archive creation
 - Final linking step
 - A success or failure message
 6. Once the build completes successfully:
 - The new executable appears in the **Available Executables** list
 - Use the “**Select for Run**” dropdown to choose the newly built executable
 - If `ESTAS_II` already exists (pre-compiled), you may use that instead

Note: If you already have a compiled `ESTAS_II` executable (shown in the Available Executables list), you can skip building and proceed directly to **Step 3**. The repository includes a pre-compiled `ESTAS_II` (gfortran, 64-bit Linux).

Step 3: Exploring Input Files

1. Click “**Input Files**” in the sidebar.
2. The page has two main sections:
 - **File Browser** (left) — file list with category filter and file information
 - **File Contents / Map Display** (right) — preview panel with two tabs
3. Use the **category filter** dropdown to explore files by type:
 - *Forcing Data* — meteorological and hydrological timeseries
 - *Geometry* — box connectivity and bathymetry
 - *Initial Conditions* — starting concentrations
 - *Constants* — model parameter files
 - *Sediment* — prescribed sediment flux files
4. **Select and preview key files:**

File	Description	What to look for
<code>PELAGIC_INPUTS.json</code>	Master pelagic config	Box count, layer structure, file references
<code>ADVECTIVE_LINKS.txt</code>	Box connectivity	Transport link definitions (from → to)
<code>TEMP_TS.txt</code>	Water temperature	Time-varying forcing for all 25 boxes
<code>FLOW_TS.txt</code>	Water flow rates	Hydrodynamic forcing timeseries
<code>WCONST_04.txt</code>	Model constants	All 323 calibrated parameter values
<code>INIT_CONC_1.txt</code>	Initial conditions	Starting concentrations for 36 variables

5. **Check the File Information** panel below the file list — it shows file size, line count, detected format, and data range for timeseries files.
 6. **Switch to the “Map Display” tab** to see:
 - **Box Network** — connectivity diagram of the 25 model boxes
 - **Bathymetry Profile** — depth profile for a selected box
 - **Box Depths Overview** — comparative depth view across all boxes
-

Step 4: Reviewing Parameters

1. Click **“Parameters”** in the sidebar.
2. The page shows parameter values from the constants file (`WCONST_04.txt`), organised into 14 categories:

Category	Parameters	Description
General	1–17	Light, temperature functions, global switches
Diatoms	18–54	Diatom growth, respiration, mortality
Non-fixing Cyanobacteria	55–89	Non-N ₂ -fixing cyano processes
Fixing Cyanobacteria	90–124	N ₂ -fixing cyanobacteria processes
Other Phytoplankton	125–159	Other algae (OPA) kinetics
Zooplankton	160–192	Grazing, respiration, mortality
Detritus	193–218	Particulate organic matter
Dissolved Organics	219–234	DOM cycling
Nitrification	235–250	NH ₄ → NO ₃ transformation
Redox Chemistry	251–272	Fe, Mn, S redox
Methane	273–283	CH ₄ production and oxidation
Settling	284–297	Particle settling velocities
pH Effects	298–305	Carbonate system, alkalinity
Nostocales	306–323	Nostocales-specific parameters

3. **Select a category** (e.g., “Diatoms”) and click **“Load”**.
4. The **Parameters** table shows:
 - Parameter index number
 - Current value
 - An editable input field for each parameter
5. **For this tutorial, do not modify any parameters.** Simply review the values to familiarise yourself with the model calibration. The supplied `WCONST_04.txt` contains the latest calibrated parameter set.

Tip: If you do modify parameters, click **“Save All Changes”** to write the updated values back to the file. A `.bak` backup is created automatically before any save.

Step 5: Setting Initial Conditions

1. Click **“Initial Cond.”** in the sidebar.
2. Select the IC file: **INIT_CONC_1.txt** (default).
3. Choose a category to view. State variables are grouped into 11 categories:

Category	Variables
Nutrients	NH4-N, NO3-N, PO4-P, Dissolved Si
Dissolved Gases	Dissolved Oxygen
Phytoplankton	DIA_C, CYN_C, OPA_C, FIX_CYN_C, NOST_VEG_HET_C, AKI_C
Zooplankton	ZOO_C, ZOO_N, ZOO_P
Particulate Organics	DET_PART_ORG_C, DET_PART_ORG_N, DET_PART_ORG_P, PART_Si
Dissolved Organics	DISS_ORG_C, DISS_ORG_N, DISS_ORG_P
Carbonate System	INORG_C, TOT_ALK
Metals	FE_II, FE_III, MN_II, MN_IV, CA, MG
Sulphur	S_PLUS_6, S_MINUS_2
Allelopathy	SEC_METAB_DIA, SEC_METAB_NOFIX_CYN, SEC_METAB_FIX_CYN, SEC_METAB_NOST
Other	CH4_C

4. Click **“Load”** to display the current initial values.
5. Review the concentrations. The values represent starting conditions at simulation time 6209 (approximately 1 January of the simulation year).
6. **For this tutorial, keep the default values and proceed.**

Step 6: Configuring Model Options

1. Click **“Model Options”** in the sidebar.
2. Select a category from the dropdown. Available categories:

Category	What it controls
Zooplankton	Feeding preference, switching function selection
Redox Chemistry	Fe/Mn/S cycling switches
Light	Light limitation formulation
Cyanobacteria	N2 fixation switches, CTMI temperature model
Allelopathy	Secondary metabolite interactions
Organic Matter	DOM/POM processing options

3. Click **“Load Options”** to display the current settings.

4. The page shows two panels:
 - **Model Switches** — on/off toggles for various model features
 - **Extra Constants** — additional constants from `EXTRA_WCONST.txt`
5. **For this tutorial, keep the default options and proceed.**

Step 7: Configuring the Simulation

1. Click “**Model Config**” in the sidebar.
2. The page has three tabs: **Simulation Config**, **Run Model**, and **Output Config**.

Tab 1: Simulation Config

3. Click “**Load Configuration**” to read the current `INPUT.txt` settings.
4. Configure the 30-day tutorial run:

Setting	Value	Notes
Base Year	1998	Reference year for forcing data
Start Date	Corresponds to day 6209	~1 Jan of the simulation year
End Date	Corresponds to day 6239	~31 Jan (30-day run)
Time Step	6 minutes (240 steps/day)	Recommended default
Output Frequency	Hourly (print interval = 10)	$10 \times 6 \text{ min} = 1 \text{ hour}$
Enable Sediment Model	Off	Faster run without sediment diagenesis
Resuspension Option	0 (Disabled)	Simplest configuration for tutorial

Alternatively — and **recommended for this tutorial** — you can simply select `INPUT_30day.txt` as the input file in the Run Model tab (next step), which already has these settings pre-configured.

5. If you modified settings, click “**Save Configuration**” to write them to the input file.

Tab 2: Run Model

6. Switch to the “**Run Model**” tab.
7. Configure the run parameters:
 - **Executable:** Select the executable you built in Step 2 (e.g., `ESTAS_gf_release`) or use the default `ESTAS_II`
 - **Input Configuration File:** Select `INPUT_30day.txt` from the dropdown — this is the pre-configured 30-day tutorial run
 - **Pelagic Constants File:** Select `WCONST_04.txt` (recommended) or leave as “(not used - use defaults)” to use built-in constants
 - **Enable Binary Output:** Leave `Off` for this tutorial

8. Check the **Command Preview** box at the bottom of the left panel. It should show something like:

```
./ESTAS_II INPUT_30day.txt WCONST_04.txt
```

If using a custom-named executable:

```
./ESTAS_gf_release INPUT_30day.txt WCONST_04.txt
```

Tab 3: Output Config

9. Switch to the “**Output Config**” tab (optional but informative).
 10. Review the **Output Boxes** selection. By default, boxes 5, 6, 8, 9, 14, 17, and 25 are selected. These are the boxes for which output files (**PELAGIC_BOX_*.out**) will be written.
 11. Review the **Output Directory**. For **INPUT_30day.txt**, output goes to **OUTPUTS_30day/**.
 12. The **Output Types** section lets you select:
 - **State Variables** — concentration timeseries (always recommended)
 - **Process Rates** — biogeochemical flux timeseries
 - **Mass Balance** — conservation check timeseries
-

Step 8: Running the Simulation

You can run the simulation from either the **Dashboard** or the **Model Config** → **Run Model** tab.

Method A: Quick Run from Dashboard

1. Navigate to the **Dashboard**.
2. Verify the System Status panel shows the correct executable and input file.
3. Click the green “**Quick Run**” button.

Method B: Run from Model Config

1. Navigate to **Model Config** → **Run Model** tab.
2. Verify the command preview is correct.
3. Click the green “**Run Model**” button.

Monitoring the Run

4. The **Run Log** panel (right side of Dashboard, or right side of Run Model tab) shows real-time output:

```
Starting quick run...
```

```
Validating input files...
```

```
OK Input files validated
```

```
OK Constants file validated: WCONST_04.txt (323 constants)
```

```
Command: ./ESTAS_II INPUT_30day.txt WCONST_04.txt
```

```
-----
```

Starting model execution...

5. The model will output progress as it processes each simulation day. A 30-day run typically completes in **2–5 minutes** depending on hardware.
6. On the Dashboard, a **timer** display shows elapsed time.
7. When the run finishes, the log shows:
OK Model completed successfully
8. To **stop a running simulation**, click the red **“Stop”** button.

What if the run fails? Check the Run Log for error messages. Common issues: -
“Executable not found” → Go to Model Build and compile first - “Missing required file”
→ Check that INPUTS/ directory has all files - “Constants file validation failed” → Select WCONST_04.txt which has all 323 required constants

Step 9: Viewing Results

1. Click **“Plots”** in the sidebar.
2. The Plots page has four tabs:
 - **Output Directory** — select which output folder to analyse
 - **Model Output** — plot state variable timeseries
 - **Input Timeseries** — visualise forcing data
 - **Data Preview** — tabular view of raw data

Selecting the Output Directory

3. In the **Output Directory** tab:
 - Select **OUTPUTS_30day** from the dropdown (or click “Refresh Directories” if it’s not listed)
 - Click **“Analyze Directory”** to see a summary of available output files

Plotting Model Output

4. Switch to the **Model Output** tab.
5. Configure the plot:
 - **File format:** Select Text (.out)
 - **Output file:** Select a box file, e.g., PELAGIC_BOX_00005.out (Box 5 — central lagoon area)
6. Select variables to plot:
 - **Left axis:** Choose one or more variables, e.g.:
 - DISS_OXYGEN — dissolved oxygen
 - NH4_N — ammonium nitrogen
 - **Right axis:** Optionally add a variable on a different scale, e.g.:
 - DIA_C — diatom carbon biomass
7. Set plot options:

- **Apply rolling mean:** Enable and set window size (e.g., 5) to smooth noisy output
 - **Log scale:** Enable for variables spanning several orders of magnitude
8. Click “**Refresh Plot**” or the plot updates automatically.
 9. The interactive Plotly chart allows:
 - **Hover** over data points to see exact values and time
 - **Zoom** by clicking and dragging to select a region
 - **Pan** by holding shift and dragging
 - **Reset zoom** by double-clicking
 - **Download** the plot as PNG using the camera icon in the toolbar

Suggested Variables to Explore

Variable	Unit	What it shows
NH4_N	mg N/L	Ammonium — key nutrient
NO3_N	mg N/L	Nitrate — nutrient, nitrification product
PO4_P	mg P/L	Phosphate — limiting nutrient
DISS_OXYGEN	mg O2/L	Dissolved oxygen — ecosystem health indicator
DIA_C	mg C/L	Diatom biomass
CYN_C	mg C/L	Non-fixing cyanobacteria biomass
FIX_CYN_C	mg C/L	Nitrogen-fixing cyanobacteria biomass
ZOO_C	mg C/L	Zooplankton biomass
INORG_C	mg C/L	Dissolved inorganic carbon
TOT_ALK	meq/L	Total alkalinity

Plotting Input Timeseries

10. Switch to the **Input Timeseries** tab.
11. Select a forcing file:
 - **Temperature** — water temperature (°C)
 - **Salinity** — water salinity (PSU)
 - **Flow** — water flow rates (m³/s)
 - **Solar Radiation** — incoming solar radiation (W/m²)
 - **Wind Speed** — wind speed (m/s)
 - **Air Temperature** — air temperature (°C)
 - **Shear Stress** — bottom shear stress (Pa)
12. Select boxes to display (e.g., “5”, “14”, “25” to compare lake regions).
13. Click “**Plot Timeseries**” to generate the chart.

Data Preview

14. The **Data Preview** tab shows raw tabular data from the currently loaded output file. Use this to inspect exact values.

Step 10: Analysing Mass Balance

1. Click “**Mass Balance**” in the sidebar.
 2. Click the “**Calculate Mass Balance**” button.
 3. The page shows:
 - **Summary table** — mass balance for Nitrogen, Carbon, Phosphorus, and Silicon showing initial mass, final mass, and relative error
 - **Element Details** — select an element (e.g., Nitrogen) to see a breakdown of all contributing state variables
 - **Time Series** — temporal evolution of total element mass over the simulation period
 4. A well-calibrated run should show mass balance relative errors below 1%. Larger errors may indicate numerical instability or configuration issues.
-

Step 11: Comparing with Observations

1. Click “**Observations**” in the sidebar.
2. The page provides two ways to load observation data:

Method A: From OBSERVATIONS directory

- Click “**Scan OBSERVATIONS Directory**” to find available files
- The bundled files include:
 - `Water_column_chemistry_2015.xlsx` — field measurements
 - `2015ST14.xlsx` — station 14 observation data
 - `PelagicProcesses.xlsx` — measured pelagic process rates
 - `.dates` files — date-indexed observation records
- Select a file and click “**Load Selected File**”

Method B: Upload your own

- Use the file upload widget to load CSV or Excel files

Method C: Generate synthetic data

- Click “**Generate Sample Data**” to create synthetic observations for testing the comparison workflow
3. After loading observations:
 - **File Preview** shows the data structure and available columns
 - **Comparison Summary** shows statistical metrics (RMSE, R^2 , bias) for matched variables
 - **Variable Details** — select a variable for detailed comparison metrics
 - **Scatter Plot Info** — model vs. observation scatter analysis
-

6. Working with Scenarios

The **Scenarios** page lets you save and restore complete model configurations.

Saving a Scenario

1. Click “**Scenarios**” in the sidebar.
2. In the “**Save Current Configuration**” panel:
 - Enter a **name** (e.g., “Tutorial_baseline”)
 - Enter a **description** (e.g., “Default 30-day run with WCONST_04”)
 - Select what to include:
 - ☒ Parameters (WCONST_04.txt)
 - ☒ Initial Conditions (select INIT_CONC_1.txt)
 - ☒ Model Options & Constants
 - Click “**Save as New Scenario**”

Loading a Scenario

3. Use the “**Select Scenario**” dropdown to choose a previously saved configuration.
4. Click “**Load**” to replace the current configuration with the saved one.
5. A scenario can be **deleted** using the “Delete” button if no longer needed.

Why use scenarios? Scenarios are particularly useful for: - Saving a calibrated baseline before making changes - Comparing different parameter sets - Quickly switching between configurations for sensitivity analysis

7. Geographic Visualization

1. Click “**Map**” in the sidebar.
 2. The map shows the Curonian Lagoon domain centred at approximately 55.32°N, 21.10°E.
 3. **Map controls:**
 - **Map Style:** Choose from OpenStreetMap, Light/Dark (Carto), Satellite (Esri), or Topographic
 - **Centre Latitude/Longitude:** Adjust map centre coordinates
 - **Zoom Level:** 1 (world) to 18 (street level); default 10
 - **Pitch (3D tilt):** Angle for 3D perspective view (default 45°)
 - **Point Radius:** Size of data points on the map
 - **Elevation Scale:** Vertical exaggeration for 3D visualisation
 4. The map also displays sample data points corresponding to model box locations.
-

8. Tips and Troubleshooting

Performance

- The **30-day simulation** (INPUT_30day.txt) is recommended for learning and testing. It completes in 2–5 minutes.

- The **365-day simulation** (`INPUT.txt`) takes 30–60 minutes and produces ~8,700 output lines per box.
- Use **Release** build type for production runs. Debug builds are 5–10× slower but provide better error diagnostics.

Common Issues

Problem	Solution
“Executable not found”	Go to Model Build and compile, or verify <code>ESTAS_II</code> exists
“Missing required file”	Check <code>INPUTS/</code> directory has <code>PELAGIC_INPUTS.txt</code> , <code>PELAGIC_MODEL_OPTIONS.txt</code> , <code>TEMP_TS.txt</code> , <code>FLOW_TS.txt</code> , <code>ADVECTIVE_LINKS.txt</code> , <code>INIT_CONC_1.txt</code>
“Constants file validation failed”	Use <code>WCONST_04.txt</code> which has all 323 required constants
Run produces NaN or crashes	Try Debug build type to get detailed error output; check initial conditions for zero or negative values
“Intel runtime libraries not found”	Only relevant for ifort-compiled executables; use gfortran instead
Plot shows no data	Verify the output directory matches the <code>INPUT</code> file configuration; click “Refresh Files”
App won’t start	Check Python environment: <code>pip install -r shiny_app/requirements.txt</code>

Navigating Efficiently

- Use the **Dashboard** for a quick overview and one-click model run
- The **Model Structure** diagram provides a visual reference of all biogeochemical interactions — useful when interpreting output variables
- The **State Variables Reference** (question mark icon in header) provides a quick-reference table of all 36 state variables
- The **Settings** panel (gear icon) allows theme customisation

File Safety

- All parameter and IC file edits create automatic `.bak` backups
- The app writes directly to `INPUTS/` files — use Scenarios to save checkpoints before major changes
- Output files are overwritten on each new run into the configured directory

9. Data Files Reference

Input Configuration Files (`INPUT*.txt`)

These files sit in the project root and control the overall simulation.

File	Duration	Resuspension	Sediment Model	Output Folder	Notes
INPUT_30day.txt	30 days	Disabled (0)	Off	OUTPUTS_30day/	Tutorial — recommended
INPUT.txt	365 days	Semi-prescribed (2)	Off	OUTPUTS/	Full annual simulation
INPUT_gf_365days.txt	365 days	—	—	—	Release build config
INPUT_gf_365debug.txt	365 days	—	—	—	Debug build config
INPUT_gf_365fast.txt	365 days	—	—	—	Fast build config
INPUT_debug_run.txt	—	—	—	OUTPUTS_debug_run/	Debugging configuration
INPUT_sediment_test.txt	—	—	On	—	Sediment model testing

Key Input Data Files (INPUTS/)

File(s)	Category	Description
PELAGIC_INPUTS.txt	Core	Master pelagic model configuration; references all other input files
PELAGIC_MODEL_OPTIONS.txt	Core	Model on/off switches and feature toggles
WCONST_04.txt	Constants	323 calibrated model constants (recommended set)
EXTRA_WCONST.txt	Constants	Additional constants for extended features
INIT_CONC_1.txt	Initial Cond.	Initial state variable concentrations (set 1)
INIT_CONC_2.txt	Initial Cond.	Initial state variable concentrations (set 2)
ADVECTIVE_LINKS.txt	Geometry	Advective transport links between boxes
DISPERSIVE_LINKS.txt	Geometry	Dispersive transport links between boxes

File(s)	Category	Description
BATHYMETRY_1.txt – BATHYMETRY_25.txt	Geometry	Depth profiles for each of the 25 boxes
TEMP_TS.txt	Forcing	Water temperature timeseries (all boxes)
SALT_TS.txt	Forcing	Salinity timeseries
FLOW_TS.txt	Forcing	Water flow rates
SOLAR_RAD_TS.txt	Forcing	Solar radiation timeseries
WIND_SPEED_TS.txt	Forcing	Wind speed timeseries
AIR_TEMP_TS.txt	Forcing	Air temperature timeseries
CLOUD_COVER_TS.txt	Forcing	Cloud cover timeseries
EVAPORATION_TS.txt	Forcing	Evaporation timeseries
BOUNDARY_FLOW_TS.txt	Forcing	Boundary flow timeseries
FORC_TS_1.txt – FORC_TS_9.txt	Forcing	Boundary concentration forcing timeseries
SETTLING_VELOCITY_TS_1.txt – –_6.txt	Forcing	Variable settling velocity timeseries
SHEAR_STRESSES_TS.txt	Forcing	Bottom shear stress timeseries
ICE_COVER.txt	Forcing	Ice cover timeseries
ALLELOPATHIC_INFORMATION.txt	Config	Allelopathic interaction parameters
PRESCRIBED_SEDIMENT_FLUXES.txt	Sediment	Prescribed benthic sediment fluxes
PRESCRIBED_SEDIMENT_FLUXES_HYPOXIA.txt	Sediment	Hypoxic sediment flux set
FLUXES_FOR_MUDDY_SEDIMENTS.txt	Sediment	Muddy sediment flux data (various sets)
FLUXES_FOR_SANDY_SEDIMENTS.txt	Sediment	Sandy sediment flux data
PELAGIC_OUTPUT_INFORMATION.txt	File	Controls which boxes produce output
RESUSPENSION_INPUTS_2.txt	Sediment	Resuspension configuration

Output Files (OUTPUTS_30day/)

After a successful 30-day run:

File	Content
PELAGIC_BOX_00005.out	Box 5 state variable timeseries
PELAGIC_BOX_00006.out	Box 6 state variable timeseries
PELAGIC_BOX_00008.out	Box 8 state variable timeseries
PELAGIC_BOX_00009.out	Box 9 state variable timeseries
PELAGIC_BOX_00014.out	Box 14 state variable timeseries
PELAGIC_BOX_00017.out	Box 17 state variable timeseries
PELAGIC_BOX_00025.out	Box 25 state variable timeseries
PELAGIC_BOX_*.mtrx	Process rate matrices (if enabled)
MASS_BALANCES.out	Element mass balance timeseries
WATER_LEVELS.out	Water level timeseries for all boxes

Observation Files (OBSERVATIONS/)

File	Description
Water_column_chemistry_2015	Field water chemistry measurements
2015ST14.xlsx	Station 14 monitoring data
PelagicProcesses.xlsx	Measured pelagic process rates
Growth_fixation_light_mixing	Growth and fixation measurements
N2_fix_rates for model	N2 fixation rate data
calibration.xlsx	
sta1ND.dates, sta2VM.dates	Station date index files

This tutorial was prepared for ESTAS-AQUABC v0.2. For model equations and scientific background, see the [AQUABC Reference Manual](#) and [ESTAS Reference Manual](#).